I. Introduction

As an international student, a problem that I came across is the inconvenience when I try to find the most valuable exchange rate regularly. It is time consuming as I need to open multiple exchange rate provider apps just to compare and find out which offers the best price. Also, exchange rates are volatile, so I often miss out on good deals because I can't check them every time due to my schedule. If this pattern continues, people who choose convenience over value will make a significant loss.

Therefore, I came up with an idea to develop an app called “BestRate” to solve this gap. It is a fintech mobile app that helps users to compare exchange rates and present the one that offers the best price to help the user's decision-making. This app is developed in hope that it can help users to get best value while being convenient when doing currency exchange rates.

i. App Concept

To use BestRate, users enter the currencies and the amount they want to exchange. Then BestRate will shows the ranked result from multiple providers. The provider that has the lowest total cost, including additional fees will be placed on top so user can find it quickly. User can see the price breakdown on the next page and when the user clicks the “Exchange Now” button, they will be redirected to the provider they selected to complete the transaction. Another function is a notification feature, where BestRate can notify users when their set-up target rate is hit so they don’t miss the best price even if they have a busy schedule.

BestRate's target audience is people that exchange currencies regularly, like international students and travelers. Both of them want to make an informed financial decision when exchanging currencies to prevent loss because of the hidden fees or missing the good rate.

ii. UI Trends & Design Justification

a) Dark-First Design

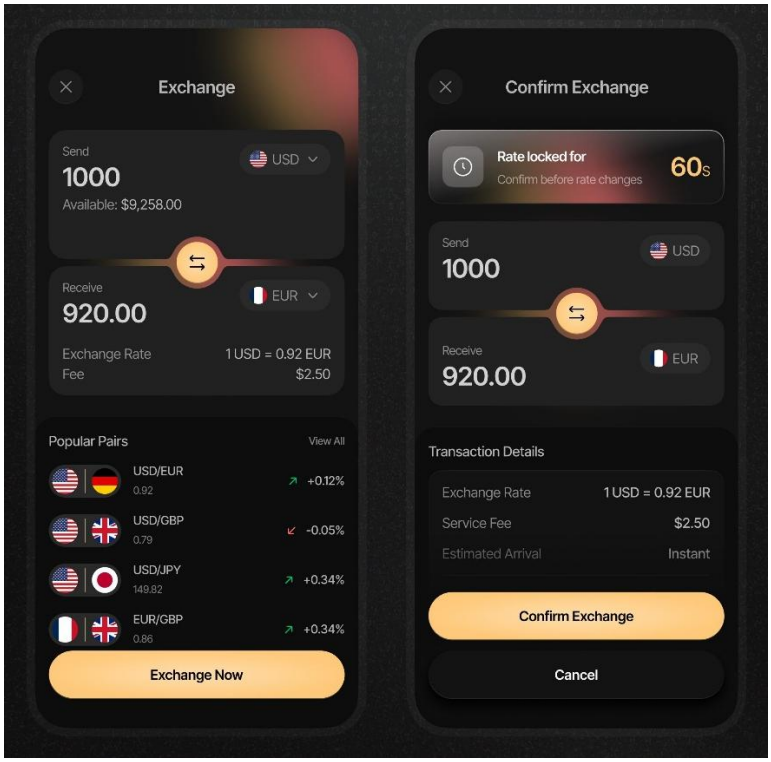


Figure 1. Dark-First Design UI Example (Dribble)

(Craft Innovations, 2025) mention that fintech apps follows the dark mode trend to help reducing eye strain, minimise glare, and save the battery life on OLED screens. Following the trend, BestRate is designed with a dark theme to improve the readability and user eye health for long-term usage. Because users will need to check the exchange rates often, including in environments with low lighting.

Other than that, dark background helps highlight important numbers and buttons more clearly, which is essential in a fintech app. Because key elements like rates, prices, and call to action buttons will stand out, helping users to make more accurate and quick decision when comparing exchange rates. Therefore, this approach is not only for aesthetics but to support a better user experience in the fintech context.

b) Card-Based Layout

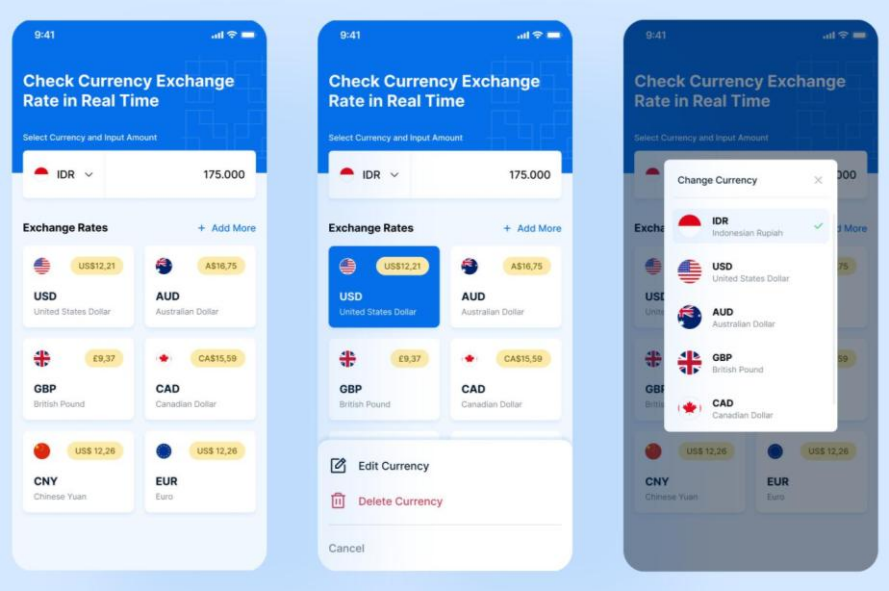


Figure 2. Card-Based Layout UI Example (Dribble)

Based (Grace, 2025), modern apps use card layouts to keep information structured and easy to scan. BestRate uses this layout, where each provider will be separated into individual cards so users can scan and compare them quickly without getting overwhelmed. It makes user can focus on one provider at a time, rather than reading a long list of data. This will make the comparison go faster and clearer, helping users make decisions efficiently without being overloaded with information.

c) Minimalist Design

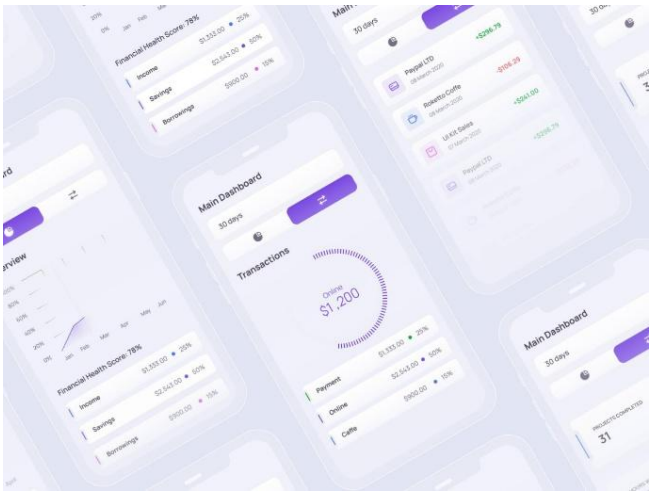


Figure 3. Minimalist UI Example (Dribble)

According to (Lopes, 2025), minimalist design is a trend in modern mobile apps, aiming to reduce clutter to help user complete their task faster without confusion. BestRate applies this design by using one unique color to highlight important buttons or information to attract user focus. Also by using one font type to keep the consistency and apply spacing between the elements to prevent overcrowding, helping user to read each section easier.

d) Data Visualisation

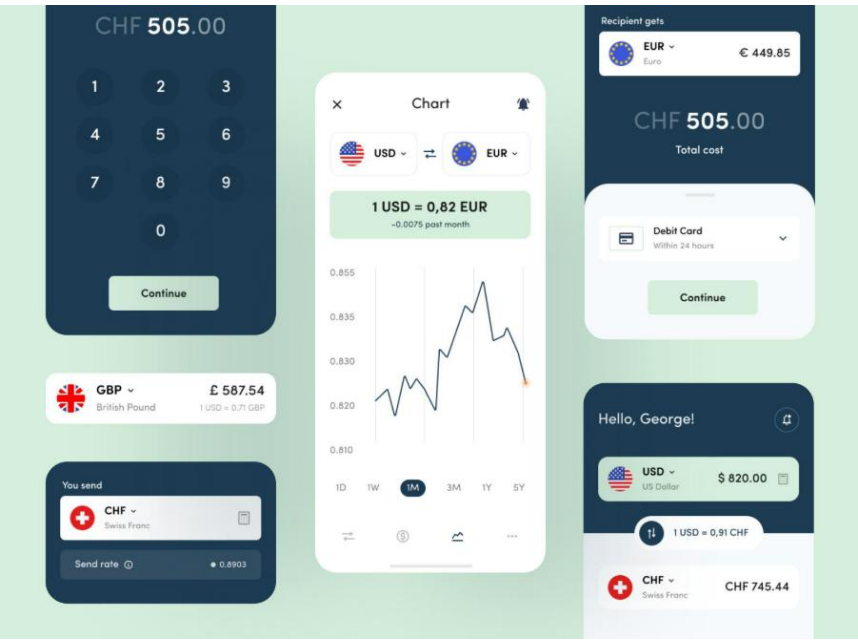


Figure 4. Data Visualisation UI Example (Dribble)

(Mandlik, 2024) highlights that the use of data visualization, like charts and graphs, is also a trend in fintech to present financial information clearly. It's stated to help users quickly understand complex data. In the detail page, BestRate use a line graph to show the one-day rate with its timestamp to show the ups and downs. It will also highlight the lowest and highest rate, so the user can easily understand the pattern.

iii. UX Principles & Design Justification

a) Content-First Layout

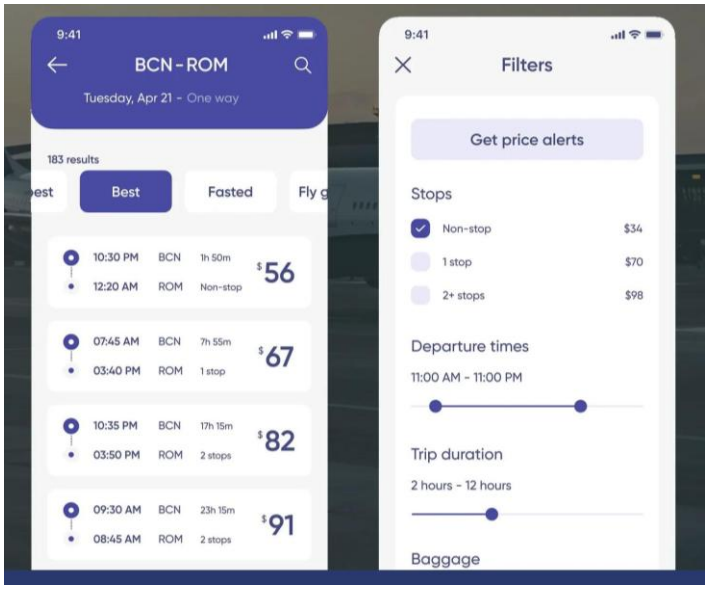


Figure 5. Content-First Layout UI Example (RealDataApi)

According to (Roy, 2025), fintech app need to avoid giving too much information for the user because it can confuse and slow them down. BestRate follows the content-first layout principles, where it shows the most important content at the top like the lowest price and its provider, so user can quickly find it without reading too much. Also, BestRate will show price breakdown on the next page after the user click certain provider, so they won't be too overloaded with the info on one page. This structure won’t confuse the user and allow quick decisions.

b) Visual Hierarchy

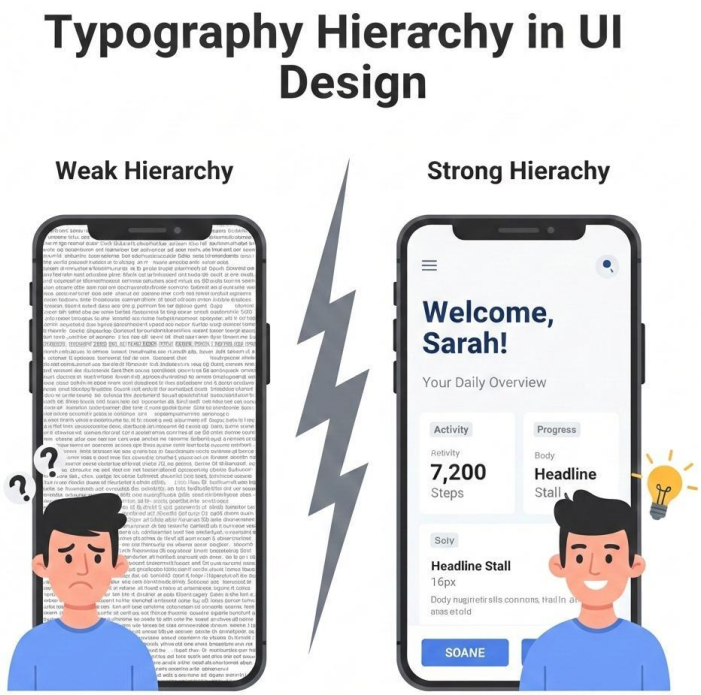


Figure 6. Visual Hierarchy UI Example (Medium)

(Gordon, 2021) mentioned that visual hierarchy helps users see information in order of importance, (Agarwal, 2025) added, as it improves the clarity when reading financial data, making it essential in fintech apps. Visual hierarchy is used in BestRate design to make important information, like the final price result, presented in a larger, bolder, and unique colour, making it stand out. Where less important info will use a smaller and thinner font with normal colour. This will direct the user's focus to the important info, without needing extra effort to find it.

c) Feedback System

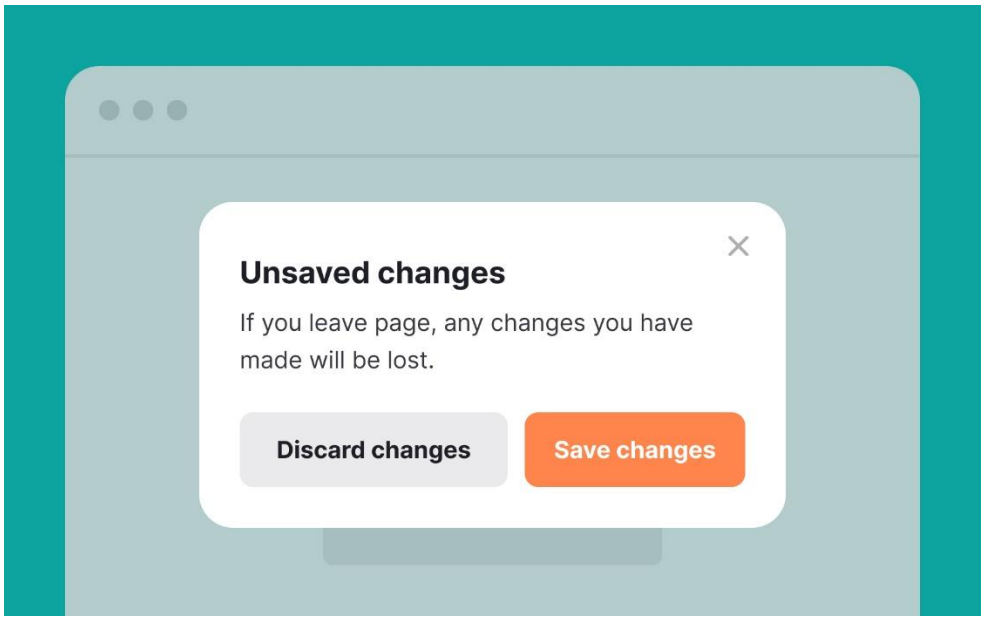
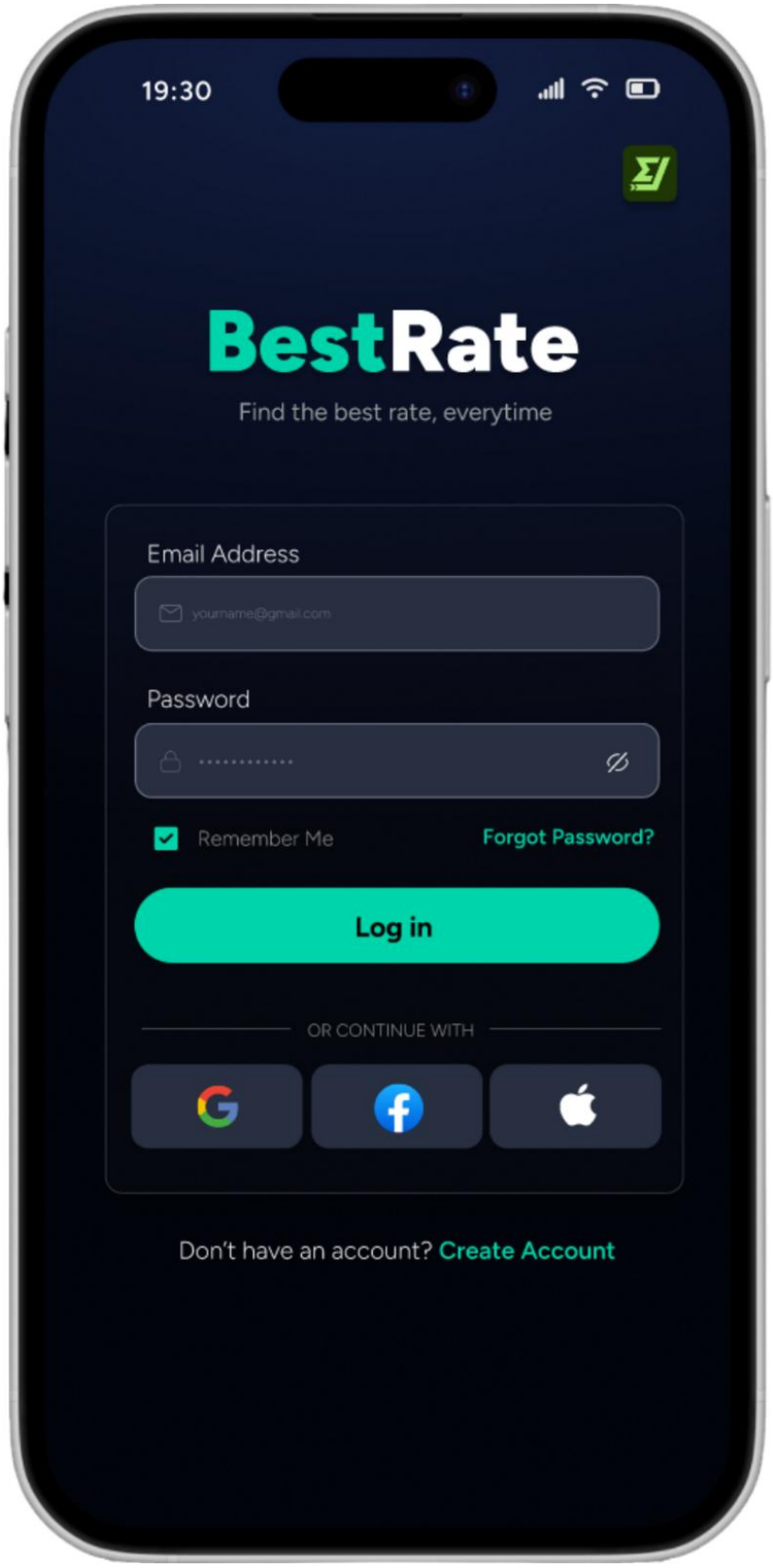


Figure 7. Feedback System UI Example (Uxcel)

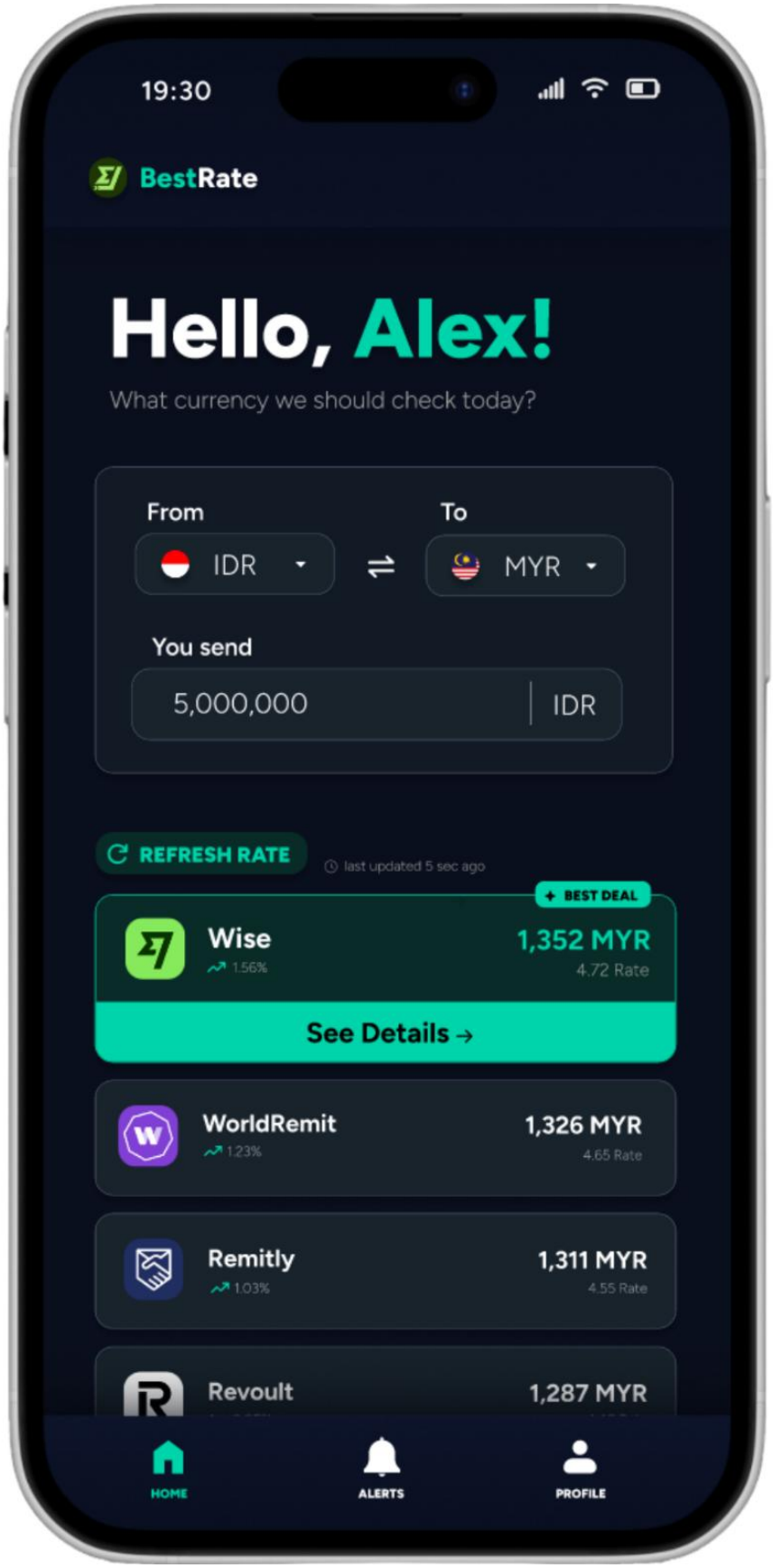
(Nielsen, 2024) mentioned that system status should be provided to make sure that users know what is happening at all times. (Flaherty, 2024) added that a clear feedback system will reduce user uncertainty and help them understand system response during the interaction. In BestRate, alerts are sent when issues happen, such as failed login attempts. It will also show a feedback of the problem to helping user to fix it. Modals will also be used when important actions will be executed, such as reset password or enabling features to make user understand clearly before proceeding. Applying these will make the interface more responsive, reduce errors, and improving user experience as user won't feel stuck and confused.

II. UI Design

i. Log-in Page



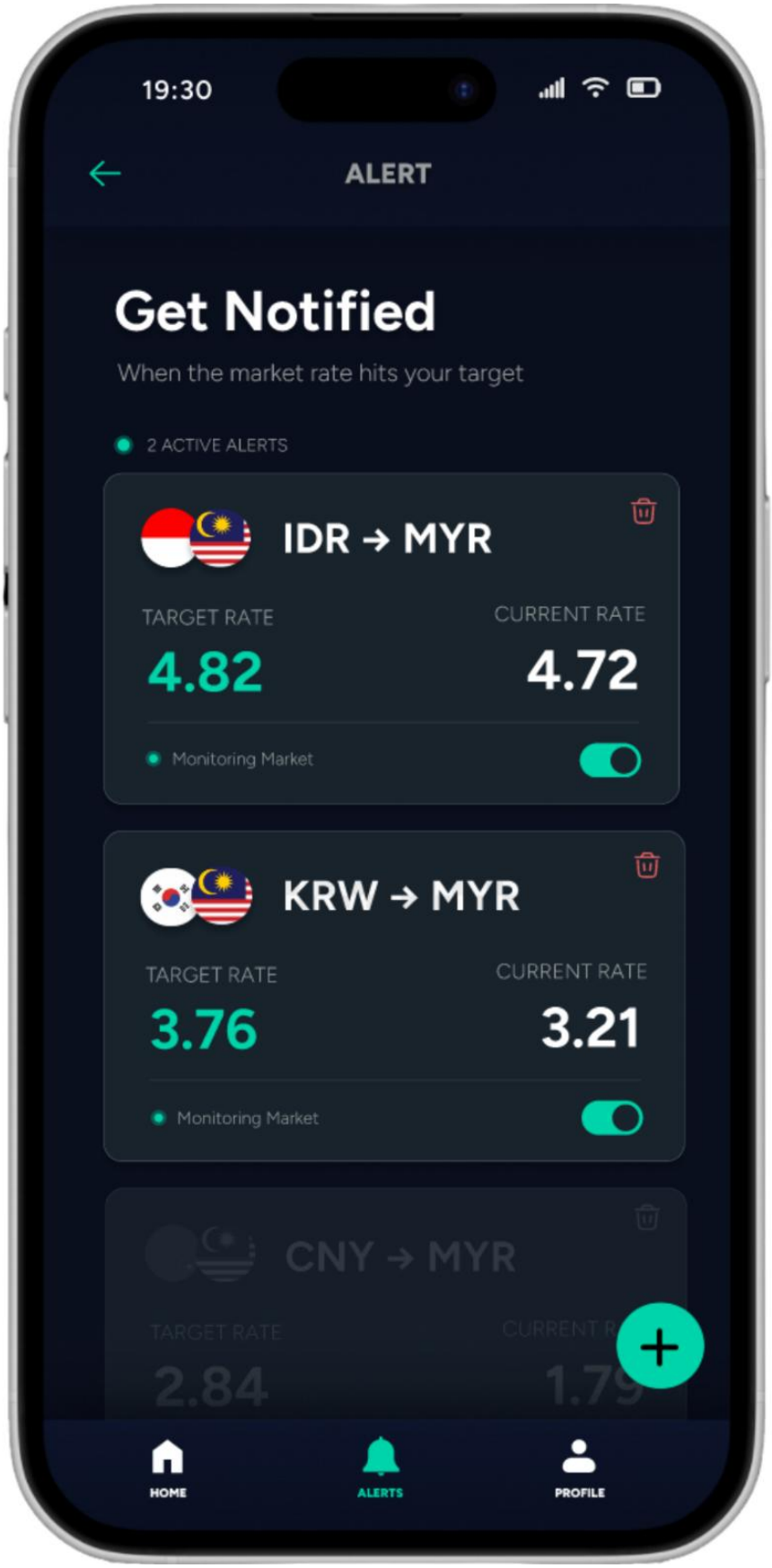
ii. Home Page


19:30
BestRate
Hello, Alex!
What currency we should check today?
From
IDR
To
MYR
You send
5,000,000
IDR
REFRESH RATE
last updated 5 sec ago
BEST DEAL
Wise
1.56%
1,352 MYR
4.72 Rate
See Details →
WorldRemit
1.23%
1,326 MYR
4.65 Rate
Remitly
1.03%
1,311 MYR
4.55 Rate
Revoult
1,287 MYR
HOME
ALERTS
PROFILE

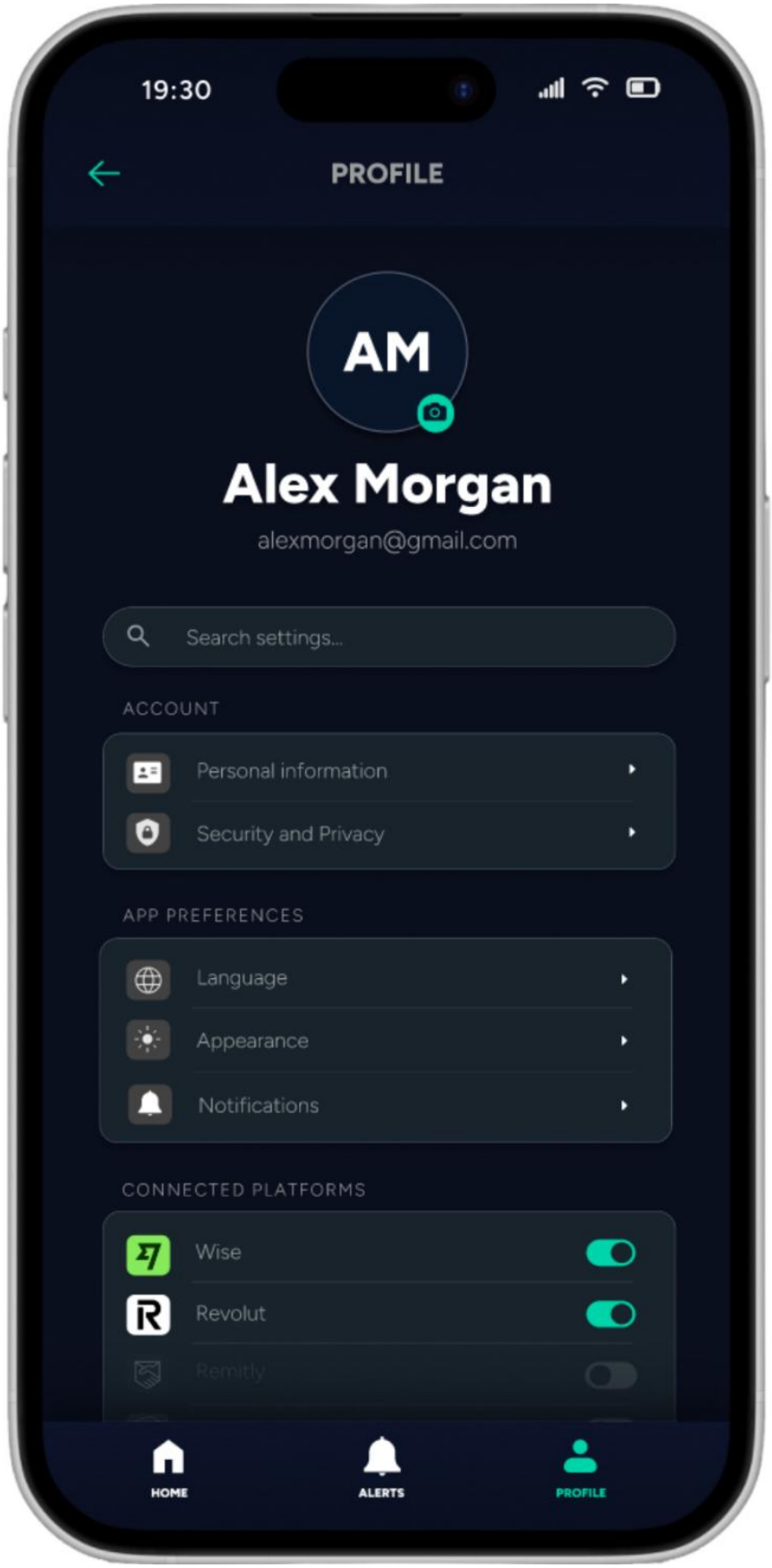
iii. Details Page



iv. Alert Page



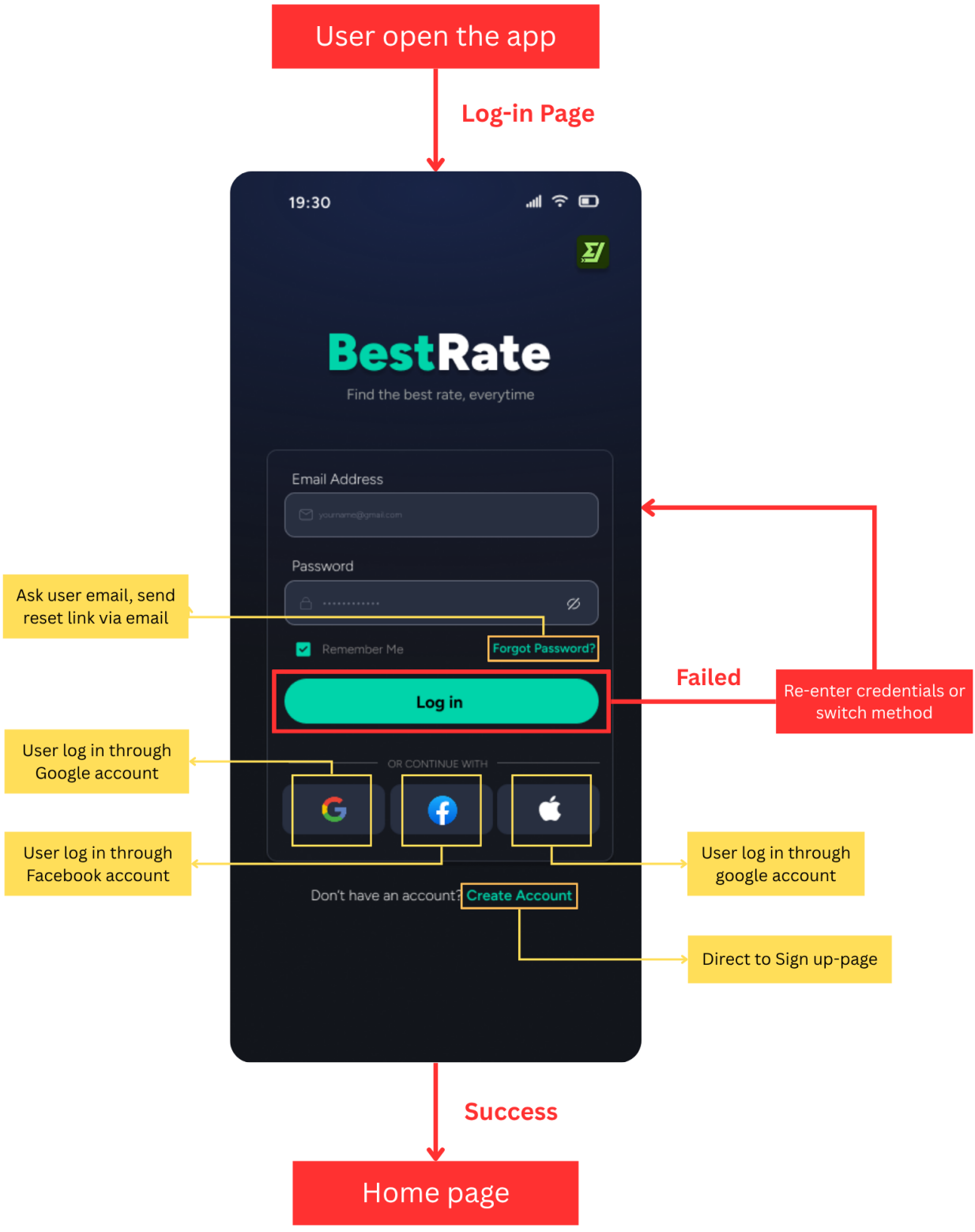
v. Profile Page



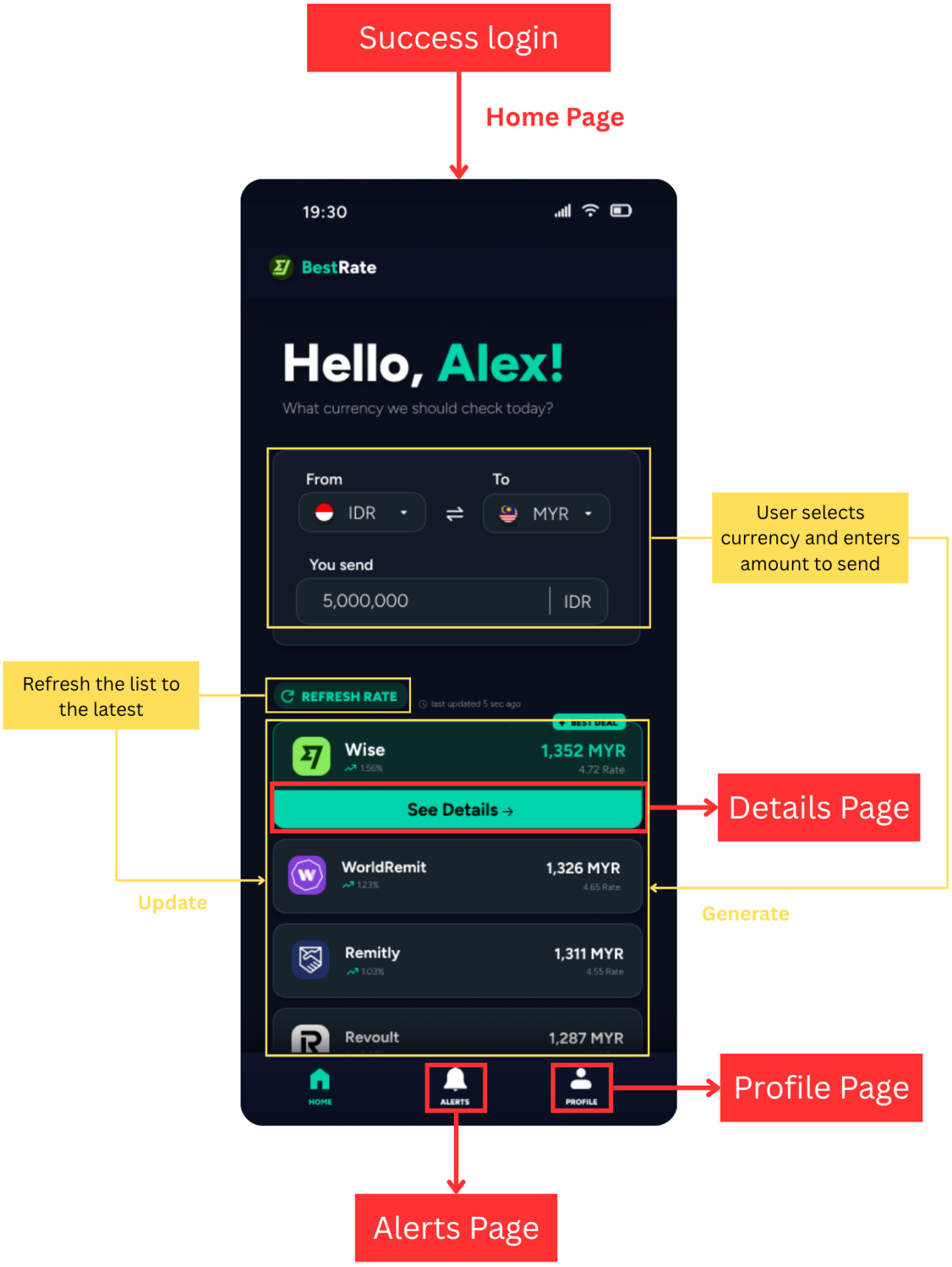
III. Programming Concept

i. Diagram

a) Log-in Page



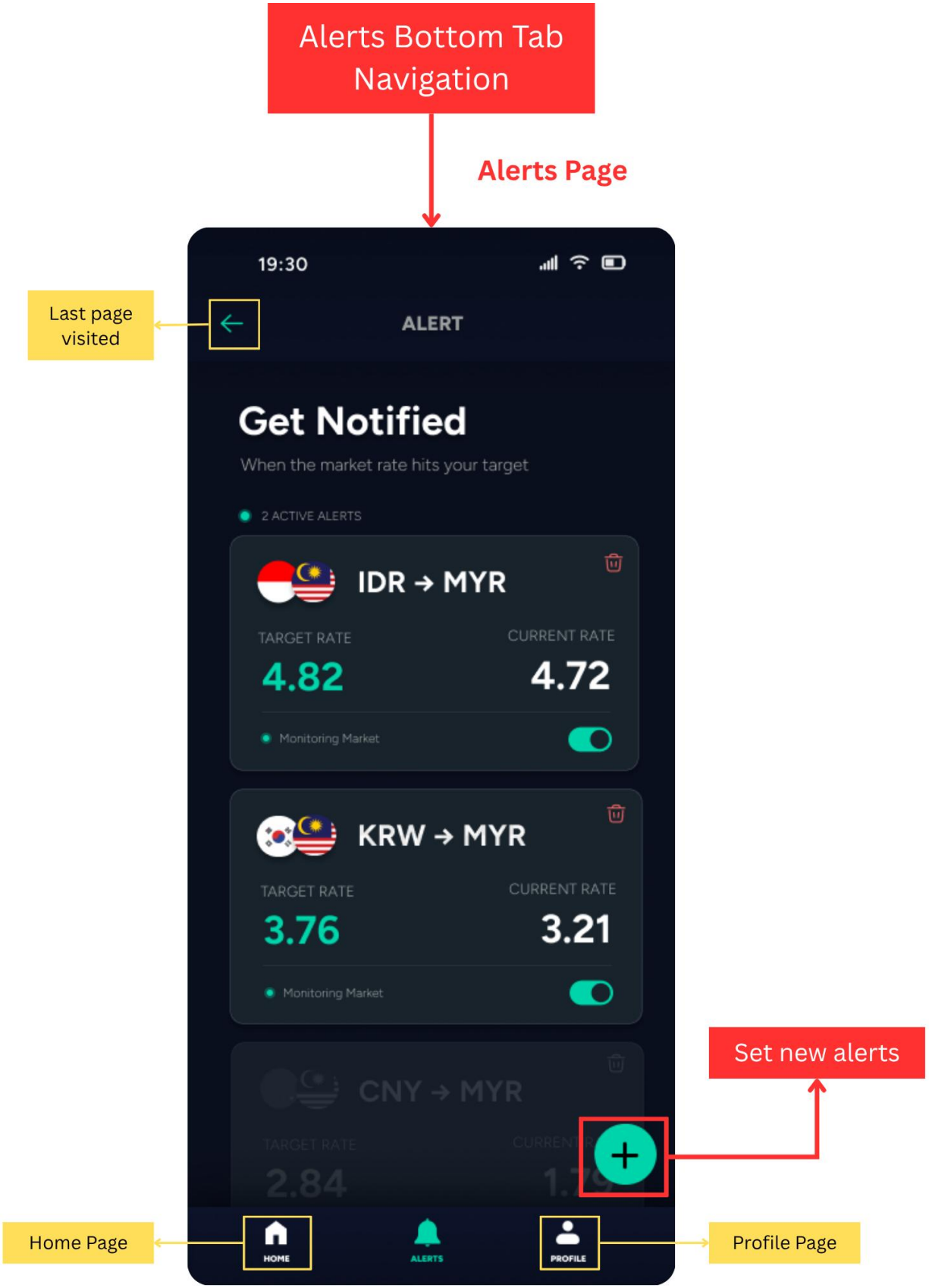
b) Home Page


Success login
Home Page
19:30
BestRate
Hello, Alex!
What currency we should check today?
From
IDR
To
MYR
You send
5,000,000
IDR
User selects currency and enters amount to send
Refresh the list to the latest
REFRESH RATE
last updated 5 sec ago
Wise
1,352 MYR
4.72 Rate
See Details →
Details Page
WorldRemit
1,326 MYR
4.65 Rate
Update
Generate
Remitly
1,311 MYR
4.55 Rate
Revoult
1,287 MYR
HOME
ALERTS
PROFILE
Profile Page
Alerts Page

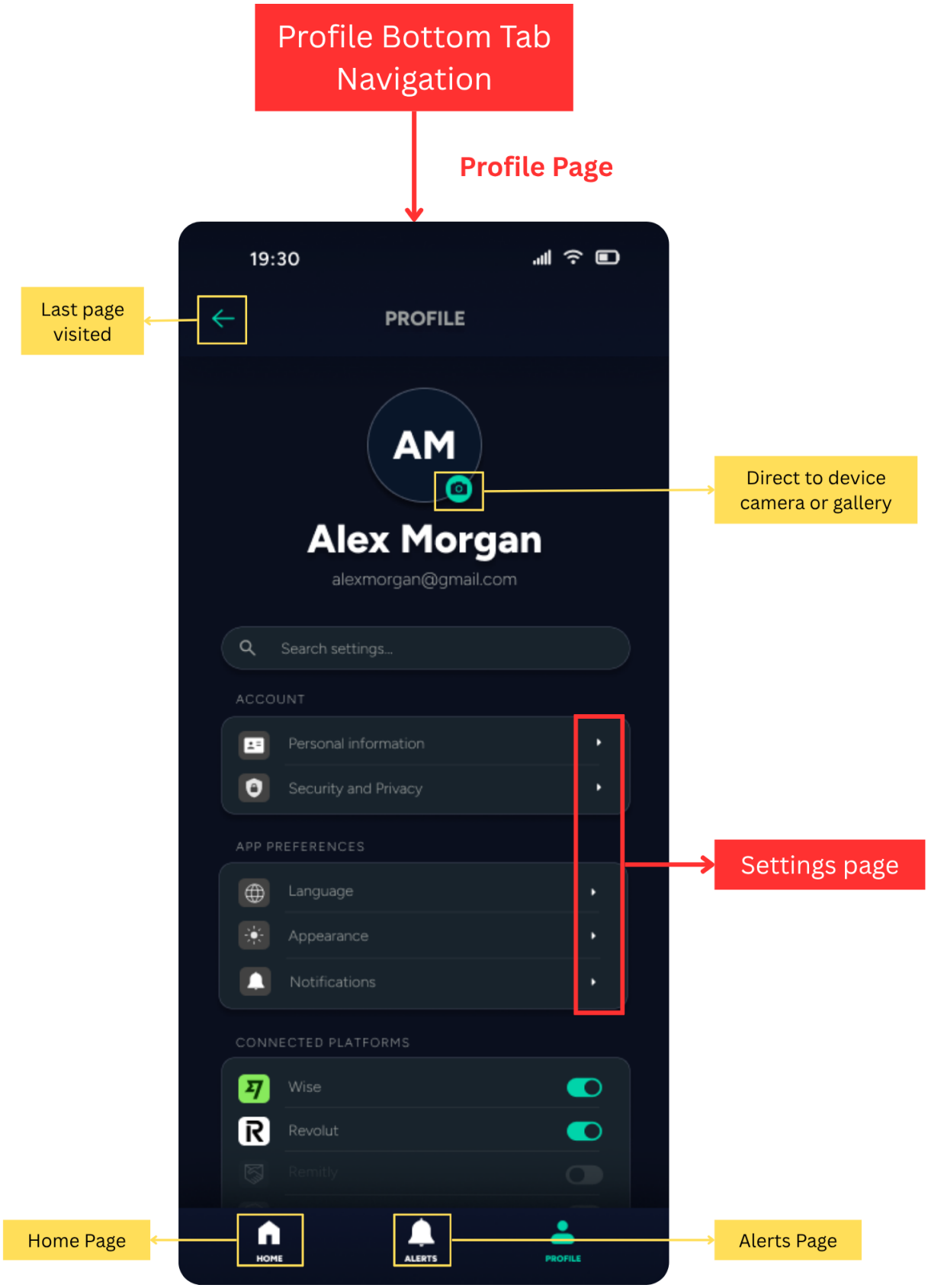
c) Details Page



d) Alerts Page



e) Profile Page



ii. Explanation

The diagrams show the navigation flow for each page; red indicates the main navigation, while yellow indicates the secondary. The app uses bottom tab navigation for main sections, stack navigation to move to other pages, and alerts for confirmations without leaving the current screen.

The flow starts when the user opens the app it is directed to the log-in page. To log in, the user needs to enter their email address and password. After entering the details, the user clicks the log-in button. If it is successful, the user will be directed to the home page. If the user fails, there will be alerts of the login failure reason. If a user forgets their password, they can click 'Forgot Password', where an alert will appear to enter the user's email and agree to send the reset password link via their entered email. There are also other options to log in using third-party accounts, such as Google, Facebook, and Apple. New users need to click 'Create Account,' which will direct them to the sign-up page. After creating their account, they can go back to the log-in page to continue.

The home page can be accessed from the login page or via the bottom tab navigation. On the home page, users need to input the currency they are sending from, the currency they are sending to, and the amount they wish to send. Then, the app will generate the receivable amount from different providers in a ranked structure, where the cheapest option is placed on top. Users can change the currencies and amount at any time, and the results will automatically update in real time. The refresh rate button allows one to refresh the rate to the newest in the market and auto-update the last updated time displayed. When the user clicks the provider's card, it will display a 'See Details' button. Clicking the button will direct the user to the details page. On the home page, there is a bottom tab navigation; clicking the alert icon will direct you to the alert page, and clicking the profile icon will direct you to the profile page.

The details page displays information based on the provider selected; in this case, Wise. It presents a breakdown of the receivable amount, including all applicable fees. A line graph of the current day's exchange rate is also shown, allowing users to easily view the highest and lowest rates over time. If the user wants to do the transaction, they need to click 'Exchange Now' to be redirected to the provider's platform to continue the transaction. If the connection with the platform is enabled, the redirection will be successful. However, if the connection is disabled, an alert will appear, telling the user and redirecting to the profile page to enable it. The back button allows users to return to the home page. The alert page and profile page can be accessed through the bottom tab navigation.

The alert page is accessed from the alert bottom navigation tab. Here, the user can see their ongoing alerts and set up new alerts, and when the target rate is reached, it automatically sends a notification to the user. To set up, the user clicks the '+' button on the bottom right. It will show a model alert where the user inputs the currencies and the target rate; then, clicking 'yes' will auto-add the alert. In each alert, there is a trash icon to delete the alert and a toggle button to disable the alert. The back button will direct to the latest page. The home page and profile page can be accessed through the bottom tab navigation.

The profile page is accessed from the profile's bottom navigation tab. The user can change the profile icon by clicking the camera button, which will direct them to the device camera or gallery based on the user's choice. A search bar is provided so the user can quickly access the settings needed. On each settings option, there is an arrow on the far right that directs them to the settings page based on what they choose. For the connected platforms, users can enable and disable the connection through the toggle button. Clicking "Exchange Now" on the detail page may, if enabled, take users to the provider's page. If disabled, an alert will be shown indicating the connection is not active. If the required provider's app is not installed, the system will notify

the user that it is missing and prompt them to download it. The back button will direct to the latest page. The home page and alert page can be accessed through the bottom tab navigation.

IV. Reflection

The insights that I get form this project is that design is not only about visual and aesthetic but also about user needs. I found that even a visually aesthetic app will not work without this kind of mindset if the user finds difficulty and the app doesn't meet the user's expectations. Another important lesson is that each design decision, like layout, typography, colors or other visual elements has its own functional outcomes, so every placement need a reason. As example in my project, BestRate use a card-based layout not just for the looks, but its to reduce the user's cognitive load when user comparing multiple financial providers at the same time.

Not just limited to visual appearance, flow navigation also need to follow user thinking. As example, adding a back button on certain pages and bottom navigation on every single page so users never feel stuck, helping them to access the feature they want. So it is needed to think from user perspective in every stage, not just relying on the developer logic.

In my future project, I would like to involve real user before I finalize the design, where I ask them to test my low-fidelity prototype. This will help me gather more edge cases, like what happened if user want to go back in the middle of the flow. This is important as fixing these minor issues will increase the reliability of the apps as it is fulfilling the user needs. In conclusion, this project shifts my perspective of designing from aesthetics to problem-solving.

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